DAILY ACTIVE RECALL · MASTER MATRIX & FACTS

ANCIENT INDIA

प्राचीन भारत का इतिहास — उच्च-प्राथमिकता पुनरावलोकन

Indus Valley Civilization, Vedic Literature & Philosophy, Mahajanapadas, Mauryan Administration, Ashokan Edicts, Gupta Golden Age, and Ancient Dynastic Chronologies.

- ⚡ **High-Yield Ratta Matrix**
  Concentrated prelims facts, tables & comparisons
- 🛡️ **Examiner Trap Eliminators**
  Confused pairs and high-frequency exam traps
- ⏱️ **15–20 Min Daily Read**
  Formulated for active morning memory drills
- 🎯 **Exam-Aligned Coverage**
  Curated strictly for UPPSC Prelims, RO/ARO & BEO

UP-PCS & UK-PCS Examination Resource
General Studies Paper 1 · Prelims Fast-Recall Desk

Daily Revision Master Edition · 2026
Nitish Pratap Official Library

Daily Read — High-Yield Revision Facts (Ancient India)

★ UPPCS & UKPCS Prelims Daily Fact Dump · Active Recall Cheat-Sheet

> **Exam Focus:** UPPSC Prelims (Paper 1), UKPSC Prelims (Paper 1), RO/ARO, BEO
> **Frequency:** Daily morning read (15–20 mins)
> **Question Types Covered:** Match the Following, Chronological ordering, Inscriptions vs Kings, Ashoka's 14 Major Rock Edicts, Shad-Darshana, Vedic assemblies (Sabha, Samiti, Vidatha), Vedic terms & 12 Ratnins, Mauryan & Gupta officers (Tirthas, Adhyakshas, Kumaramatya), Ancient taxes (Bhaga, Bali, Sita, Hiranya, Udranga), Land classifications, Marriage types, Ancient ports & coins, Dynasties & founders.

1. Indus Valley Civilization (IVC) Master Matrix

Site	Location / State	River	Excavator & Year	Key Unique Findings / Exam Triggers
Harappa	Sahiwal (Punjab, Pak)	**Ravi** (Left bank)	Daya Ram Sahni (1921)	6 granaries in 2 rows, Coffin burial (R-37 & H cemetery), Sandstone torso of nude male, Copper bullock cart
Mohenjodaro (*Mound of Dead*)	Larkana (Sindh, Pak)	**Indus** (Right bank)	R.D. Banerjee (1922)	**Great Bath**, **Great Granary** (largest building of Mohenjodaro), **Bronze Dancing Girl** (lost wax technique), Steatite Bearded Priest, Pashupati seal, Piece of woven cotton
Lothal	Ahmedabad (Gujarat)	**Bhogava**	S.R. Rao (1954/57)	**Tidal Dockyard** (artificial brick basin), Rice husk, Bead factory, Fire altars, Terracotta horse figurine, Persian gulf seal, Double burial (male-female)
Kalibangan (*Black Bangles*)	Hanumangarh (Rajasthan)	**Ghaggar** (ancient Saraswati)	A. Ghosh (1953), B.B. Lal & B.K. Thapar	**Ploughed field surface** (furrows), Camel bones, Row of **7 fire altars**, Wooden drainage, Decorated floor tiles, Both citadel & lower town fortified
Chanhudaro	Sindh (Pakistan)	**Indus**	N.G. Majumdar (1931), Mackay (1935)	**Only site without a citadel**, Bead-making factory, Lipstick/cosmetics, Inkpot, Imprint of dog's paw chasing a cat
Dholavira	Kutch (Gujarat) - Khadir Bet	Luni basin (Mansar & Manhar streams)	J.P. Joshi (1967), R.S. Bisht (1990)	**Three-tier city division** (Citadel, Middle Town, Lower Town), Giant **water reservoirs/dams**, Unique **10-symbol signboard**, Sports stadium; **UNESCO WHS (2021)**
Banawali	Fatehabad (Haryana)	Saraswati / Rangoi	R.S. Bisht (1974)	**Terracotta toy model of plough**, High quantity of good quality barley, Lack of systematic grid drainage
Rakhigarhi	Hisar (Haryana)	Ghaggar-Hakra	Amarendra Nath	**Largest Harappan site in India** (and overall after recent surveys)
Ropar (Roopnagar)	Punjab (India)	**Sutlej**	Y.D. Sharma (1953)	**Dog buried with human oval pit** (post-Harappan continuation), First site excavated after independence
Surkotada	Kutch (Gujarat)	Seasonal stream	J.P. Joshi (1964)	**Horse bone remains** (disputed), Pot burials, Oval citadel
Daimabad	Ahmednagar (Maharashtra)	**Pravara** (Godavari tributary)	B.P. Bopardikar	**Southernmost IVC site**, Bronze chariot with driver, Rhino, Elephant, Buffalo

Site	Location / State	River	Excavator & Year	Key Unique Findings / Exam Triggers
Alamgirpur	Meerut (Uttar Pradesh)	**Hindon** (Yamuna tributary)	Y.D. Sharma (1958)	**Easternmost IVC site** in India; cloth impression on pottery; triangle–peacock–squirrel motifs. **Not** Rakhigarhi (Haryana = largest, not east).
Hulas	**Saharanpur** (UP; some lists tag the Baghpat belt)	Upper Ganga–Yamuna doab	**K.N. Dikshit** (ASI)	Eastern Harappan habitation: handmade + wheel-made pottery, chert blades, bone points. **UPPCS match: Hulas = Uttar Pradesh** (not Gujarat).
Mandi	**Muzaffarnagar** (UP; some lists Bijnor / Ramganga)	Doab	ASI	Late Harappan **jewellery / gold-hoard** find. **Mandi (UP) ≠ Manda (J&K)**. With Hulas, the usual UP pair that rejects **Rakhigarhi**.
Sanauli	**Baghpat** (Uttar Pradesh)	Yamuna basin	D.V. Sharma / ASI (**2018**)	About **125** graves, coffins, copper antenna swords, solid wooden-wheel **chariots**. Late Harappan / OCP — **not** a Mature grid-city with a Great Bath. Same district belt as Hulas lists, different period label.
Bargaon / Ambakheri	**Saharanpur** (Uttar Pradesh)	Doab	ASI	Late Harappan / **OCP** belt of western UP (with Hastinapur, Lal Qila, Atranjikhera). Rural doab, not a citadel city.
Manda	Jammu & Kashmir	**Chenab**	J.P. Joshi (1982)	**Northernmost IVC site** in India. Trap: **Manda ≠ Mandi**.
Sutkagen Dor	Balochistan (Pak-Iran border)	**Dasht**	Aurel Stein (1927)	**Westernmost IVC site**, Coastal trading post between Harappa & Babylon
Kunal	Haryana	Saraswati	J.S. Khatri	2 silver crowns discovered
Balu	Kaithal (**Haryana**)	-	-	Earliest evidence of garlic cultivation. Trap: **Balu ≠ UP**.
Padri	Bhavnagar belt (**Gujarat**)	Coastal Saurashtra	-	**Gujarat** match in the Balu–Manda–Padri–Hulas set. Trap: **Padri ≠ Hulas**.
Bhirrana	Fatehabad (**Haryana**)	Ghaggar	ASI / L.S. Rao	Often called among the **oldest** Harappan settlements. Not a UP site.

UP Harappan quartet: Alamgirpur (Meerut, east end) · **Hulas** (Saharanpur) · **Mandi** (Muzaffarnagar) · **Sanauli** (Baghpat, Late / OCP chariots). **Rakhigarhi is Haryana**, not UP.
UKPCS — no mature Indus city in Uttarakhand. Closest protohistoric belt: **Bahadrabad (Haridwar)** — OCP + Copper Hoards (Y.D. Sharma, 1951–53); **Bankot (Pithoragarh)** — 8 copper anthropomorphs (1989); **Malari (Chamoli)** — cist graves, 5.2 kg gold mask, Swat-style pottery. Do not list these as Harappa / Mohenjodaro-type cities.

2. Vedic Civilization — Literature, Philosophy & Geography

A. Rigvedic Rivers (Ancient vs Modern Name Match-up)

Rigvedic Ancient Name	Modern Name	Rigvedic Ancient Name	Modern Name
Vitasta	Jhelum	**Saraswati**	Ghaggar / Hakra (Most sacred: *Naditama*, *Devitama*)
Asikni	Chenab	**Drishadvati**	Chautang / Rakshi
Parushni	Ravi (Battle of 10 Kings on its bank)	**Kubha**	Kabul (Afghanistan)

Rigvedic Ancient Name	Modern Name	Rigvedic Ancient Name	Modern Name
Vipas	Beas	**Suvastu**	Swat (Afghanistan)
Sutudri	Sutlej	**Krumu**	Kurram (Afghanistan)
Sindhu	Indus (Most frequently mentioned river)	**Gomati**	Gomal (Afghanistan)
Sadaneera	Gandak (Mentioned in *Shatapatha Brahmana*)	**Marudvridha**	Maruwardwan (J&K)

B. Vedic Literature & Upanishadic Dialogues (Match Goldmine)

- **Rigveda**: 10 Mandalas, 1,028 Suktas (hymns); 3rd Mandala contains **Gayatri Mantra** (composed by Vishvamitra dedicated to solar deity Savitr); 7th Mandala describes **Dasrajan Yudha** (Battle of 10 Kings on Parushni/Ravi river won by Sudas of Bharata tribe); 9th Mandala dedicated entirely to **Soma**; 10th Mandala contains **Purusha Sukta** (first mention of 4 Varnas).
- **Samaveda**: Book of chants / melodies (*Ragas*); origin of Indian classical music; chanted by *Udgatri* priests.
- **Yajurveda**: Book of sacrificial prayers and rituals; divided into **Shukla Yajurveda** (White - poetry) and **Krishna Yajurveda** (Black - prose + verse).
- **Atharvaveda**: Charms, spells, magical formulas, everyday medicine; mentions *Sabha* and *Samiti* as twin daughters of Prajapati.
- **Key Brahmanas**:
- *Aitareya & Kaushitaki*: Rigveda.
- *Shatapatha Brahmana*: Largest and oldest Brahmana (attached to Shukla Yajurveda); story of Videgha Mathava carrying Agni across Sadaneera/Gandak.
- *Gopatha Brahmana*: Attached to Atharvaveda.
- **Famous Upanishadic Dialogues (Direct UPPSC/UKPSC Match-ups)**:
- **Mundaka Upanishad**: Sourced national motto **"Satyam Eva Jayate"** (*Truth Alone Triumphs*).
- **Katha Upanishad**: Famous philosophical dialogue between young boy **Nachiketa and Yama (God of Death)** on the nature of soul and immortality.
- **Brihadaranyaka Upanishad**: Largest Upanishad; contains celebrated philosophical debate between sage **Yajnavalkya and scholarly woman Gargi**; phrase "*Tamaso Ma Jyotirgamaya*".
- **Chhandogya Upanishad**: Contains story of **Satyakama Jabala** (boy who spoke truth about his parentage admitted by sage Gautama); dialogue between Uddalaka Aruni and son Svetaketu (*Tat Tvam Asi*).
- **Jabala Upanishad**: First explicit mention of the **Four Ashramas** (Brahmacharya, Grihastha, Vanaprastha, Sanyasa).

C. Six Vedangas (Limbs of the Vedas)

1. **Shiksha**: Phonetics and Pronunciation.
2. **Kalpa**: Ritual instructions (Shrauta Sutras, Grihya Sutras, Dharma Sutras, and **Sulba Sutras — ancient Indian Geometry & measurement!**).
3. **Vyakarana**: Grammar (Panini's *Ashtadhyayi*).
4. **Nirukta**: Etymology of Vedic words (Yaska's *Nirukta*).
5. **Chhanda**: Metrics and Poetic meters (Pingala's *Chhandasastra*).
6. **Jyotisha**: Astronomy and calculation of auspicious ritual calendar (Lagadha's *Vedanga Jyotisha*).

D. Six Schools of Indian Philosophy (Shad-Darshana)

School of Philosophy	Founder / Sage	Foundational Text	Core Philosophical Principle
1. Samkhya (*Oldest school*)	**Kapila Muni**	*Samkhya Sutra*	Dualistic realism: **Purusha** (Consciousness) and **Prakriti** (Matter); 25 basic elements

School of Philosophy	Founder / Sage	Foundational Text	Core Philosophical Principle
2. Yoga	**Patanjali**	*Yoga Sutra*	Eightfold path (**Ashtanga Yoga**: Yama, Niyama, Asana, Pranayama, Pratyahara, Dharana, Dhyana, Samadhi)
3. Nyaya	**Akshapada Gautama**	*Nyaya Sutra*	Logic, epistemology, and rigorous reasoning; 4 Pramanas (Pratyaksha, Anumana, Upamana, Shabda)
4. Vaisheshika	**Kanada (Uluka)**	*Vaisheshika Sutra*	**Atomic theory (Paramanu)**; universe composed of 9 physical substances; scientific classification
5. Purva Mimamsa	**Jaimini**	*Mimamsa Sutra*	Unquestioned authority of Vedas; ritualism, Dharma, and Vedic karma
6. Uttara Mimamsa (Vedanta)	**Badarayana (Vyasa)**	*Brahma Sutra*	Philosophy of Upanishads; Brahman is supreme reality; developed by Shankara (Advaita) & Ramanuja

E. Vedic Political Assemblies (Sabha, Samiti, Vidatha, Gana)

Assembly	Composition & Nature	Presiding Officer	Primary Functions	Women's Status & Rigvedic vs Later Vedic Evolution
Sabha (सभा)	Council of select **elders, nobles, and Brahmanas**; smaller and more elite body	**Sabhapati** / *Sabhapala*	**Judicial and advisory**: arbitrated disputes, dispensed justice, advised king on state affairs	Women attended in Early Vedic (*Sabhavati*); **strictly excluded in Later Vedic** as royal power and patriarchy grew
Samiti (समिति)	**General folk assembly of the entire tribe (*Vis*)**; broad democratic body	**Pati** or **Ishan**	**Political and electoral**: elected and re-elected the *Rajan* (King), debated peace/war, discussed national policy; Rigveda hymn (X.191) ends with prayer for common consensus	Women had **no role**; strictly male tribal gathering. In Later Vedic, kings gradually subdued Samiti's electing power
Vidatha (विदथ)	**Oldest tribal assembly** (mentioned 122 times in Rigveda vs 8 times for Sabha, 9 for Samiti)	Tribal elder / seer	**Ritual, redistributive, and military**: distributed war spoils/booty, conducted folk rituals, settled domestic customs	**Women actively participated** (*Vidathya*) and debated alongside men. **Completely disappeared in Later Vedic times**
Gana (गण)	Assembly of warrior clans / general troop gathering	**Ganapati** / *Jyeshtha*	Military deliberations and tribal defense	Minor folk council; evolved into post-Vedic oligarchic Gana-sanghas

> **Crucial Prelims Triggers:** - **Atharvaveda (7.12.1)** explicitly calls **Sabha and Samiti the twin daughters of Prajapati** (*Prajapateh duhitarau*). - **Judicial function** belonged exclusively to **Sabha** (not Samiti). - **Electoral function** (election of the King) belonged to **Samiti** (not Sabha). - **Earliest assembly: Vidatha** (Rigveda's highest mention count: 122).

F. High-Yield Vedic Terms & Vocabulary (Match & Meaning Goldmine)

Frequently tested in UPPCS & UKPCS Prelims:

Ancient Vedic Term	Literal Meaning / Context	Historical & Exam Significance
Aghanya (अघन्या)	"Not to be killed / slain"	Refers to the **Cow**; highest penalty (capital punishment or expulsion) for hurting/killing
Gavishti / Gaveshana / Goshu	"Search for cows"	**War / Battle**; cattle raids were the prime cause of inter-tribal conflicts in Rigvedic era
Gopati (गोपति)	"Protector of cattle"	Title of the **King / Tribal Chief** (*Rajan*)

Ancient Vedic Term	Literal Meaning / Context	Historical & Exam Significance
Gomat (गोमत्)	"Possessor of cattle"	A **wealthy person** (wealth was measured in cattle heads, not coins/land)
Duhitri (दुहितृ)	"One who milks the cow"	**Daughter** in the family
Goghna (गोघ्न)	"One for whom a cow is offered"	A revered **Guest** visiting the household
Godhuli (गोधूलि)	"Dust raised by returning cattle"	Evening twilight / dusk (unit of time measurement)
Gavyuti (गव्यूति)	Cattle grazing radius	Unit of **distance measurement**
Kulapa (कुलप)	Head of the *Kula* (family)	Oldest male patriarch of the family
Gramani (ग्रामणी)	Leader of the *Grama* (village)	Head of village; led local militia and ranked among the 12 Ratnins
Vispati (विशपति)	Head of the *Vis* (clan / canton)	Clan chief between village (*Grama*) and tribe (*Jana*)
Vrajapati (व्राजपति)	Master of pastures	Officer in charge of pastures and cattle camps; led village warriors
Spasa (स्पश)	"Lookout / watcher"	**Spies / Intelligence agents** employed by the King/Varuna
Jivagribh (जीवगृभ्)	"One who seizes alive"	**Police official / arresting officer**
Duta (दूत)	Messenger	Royal envoy or ambassador
Yava (यव)	Food grain	**Barley** (the primary cereal of Rigvedic Aryans)
Godhuma (गोधूम)	Cereal grain	**Wheat** (widely cultivated in Later Vedic)
Vrihi (व्रीहि)	Cereal grain	**Rice** (extensively mentioned in Later Vedic texts)
Sira / Langala (सीर / लांगल)	Agricultural tool	**Plough**; *Sita* = furrow made by plough
Kinasha (कीनाश)	Field worker	**Ploughman / peasant cultivator**
Urvara / Kshetra (उर्वरा / क्षेत्र)	Land type	Fertile, cultivated agricultural field
Ayas (अयस्)	Metal	In Rigveda: **copper / bronze**; in Later Vedic: *Krishna-ayas / Shyama-ayas* = **iron**, *Lohita-ayas* = **copper**
Pani (पणि)	Trading folk	Wealthy non-Aryan traders/merchants; notorious in hymns as cattle-thieves
Bekhanata (बेखनाट)	Lender	**Usurer / Moneylender** who charged exorbitant interest rates
Nishka / Satamana (निष्क / शतमान)	Gold ornament / unit	In Rigveda: gold necklet/bullion; in Later Vedic: standardized gold unit of value

G. The 12 Vedic Ratnins (Jewel-Bearers of Royal Administration)

Mentioned in the Shatapatha Brahmana and Taittiriya Samhita during the Ratnahavimshi ceremony of the Rajasuya Yajna (King visits each official's home to offer oblation):

#	Ratnin (Jewel-Official)	Exact Designation / Official Portfolio	Key UPPCS Exam Trap
1	**Purohita** (पुरोहित)	Chief Royal Priest and chief political adviser to Rajan	Invariable first counselor of the realm
2	**Senani** (सेनानी)	Commander-in-Chief of the military forces	Leads the army in times of war
3	**Gramani** (ग्रामणी)	Village headman / leader of the rural militia	Represents rural folk in the royal circle

#	Ratnin (Jewel-Official)	Exact Designation / Official Portfolio	Key UPPCS Exam Trap
4	**Mahishi** (महिषी)	Chief Queen (first legally wedded queen)	Participated in royal consecration rites
5	**Suta** (सूत)	Charioteer, royal court minstrel, and herald	Chronicler of heroic royal deeds
6	**Sangrahitri** (संग्रहीतृ)	**Treasurer / Custodian of royal store**	Stores revenue and tribute
7	**Bhagadugha** (भागदुघ)	**Collector of the King's share (*Bhaga*) of revenue / taxes**	**UPPCS Trap:** Collects revenue (do NOT confuse with Akshavapa)
8	**Akshavapa** (अक्षावाप)	**Superintendent of gambling & royal dice accountant**	**UPPCS Trap (2023):** Dice/gambling officer, NOT revenue collector!
9	**Govikartana** (गोविकर्तन)	Keeper of forests, game master, companion in the royal hunt	Head of livestock and hunting preserves
10	**Palagala** (पालागल)	Royal courier, messenger, and confidential king's companion	Diplomatic emissary
11	**Kshattri** (क्षात्तृ)	Royal chamberlain / master of the royal household gate	Managed inner palace affairs
12	**Takshan / Rathakara** (तक्षन् / रथकार)	Chief carpenter and chariot-builder	Highest artisan status due to importance of chariots in war

3. 16 Mahajanapadas & Their Capitals (6th Century BCE)

Mahajanapada	Capital	Modern Location	High-Yield Exam Notes
Magadha	Girivraja / Rajagriha → Pataliputra	Patna & Gaya (Bihar)	Founded by Brihadratha; rose under Bimbisara (Haryanka)
Anga	**Champa** (ancient Malini)	Bhagalpur & Munger (Bihar)	Annexed by Bimbisara; major trade port to Suvarnabhumi
Kasi	**Varanasi**	Varanasi (UP)	Between Varuna and Asi rivers; famous for cotton textiles
Vatsa	**Kausambi**	Prayagraj/Kaushambi (UP)	King **Udayana** (hero of Bhasa's *Swapnavasavadattam*); Buddha visited
Kosala	**Sravasti** (North) / Saketa (South)	Ayodhya/Faizabad & Bahraich (UP)	King **Prasenjit** (contemporary of Buddha); Buddha spent most rainy seasons here
Saurasena	**Mathura**	Mathura (UP)	King Avantiputra (disciple of Buddha); Megasthenes mentions worship of Herakles (Krishna)
Panchala	**Ahichchhatra** (North, Bareilly) & **Kampilya** (South, Farrukhabad)	Rohilkhand & Central UP	Kannauj was part of it; transition from tribal to urban center
Kuru	**Indraprastha** (near Delhi) / Hastinapur	Meerut, Delhi, Thanesar	Shifted capital to Kaushambi after Hastinapur was flooded (Nichakshu)
Matsya	**Viratnagar** (Bairat, Jaipur)	Alwar, Bharatpur, Jaipur (Raj)	Hiding place of Pandavas; King Sujata
Chedi	**Suktimati** / Sotthivati	Bundelkhand (UP/MP)	King Shishupala (killed by Krishna in Mahabharata)
Avanti	**Ujjayini** (North) & **Mahishmati** (South)	Malwa / MP	King **Pradyota** (Mahasena); Jivaka (Bimbisara's physician) sent to treat his jaundice

Mahajanapada	Capital	Modern Location	High-Yield Exam Notes
Gandhara	**Taxila** (Takshashila) & Pushkalavati	Rawalpindi / Peshawar (Pak)	Famous university; King Pushkarasarin sent embassy to Bimbisara
Kamboja	**Rajpur** / Hataka	Rajouri & Hazara (NW frontier)	Famous for fine breed of horses; mentioned by Kautilya as *Varta-Shastropajivi*
Asmaka (Assaka)	**Potana** / Potali	Banks of river **Godavari** (Telangana/Maha)	**ONLY Mahajanapada situated south of the Vindhyas**
Vajji	**Vaishali**	Muzaffarpur / Vaishali (Bihar)	Confederacy of 8 clans (Lichchhavis, Videhas, Jnatrikas); First republican state
Malla	**Kushinagar** & **Pawa**	Deoria / Gorakhpur (UP)	Republican Gana-sangha; Buddha died at Kushinagar; Mahavira died at Pawa

UKPCS Special Note: Ashoka's Major Rock Edict in Uttarakhand is at **Kalsi** (Dehradun district) on the confluence of the Yamuna and Tons rivers.

4. Ashoka's 14 Major Rock Edicts (MRE) — Complete Cheat-Sheet

Edict	Core Subject / Mandate Inscribed
Major Rock Edict I	Prohibition of animal slaughter and festive gatherings (*Samaja*).
Major Rock Edict II	Medical treatment for men and animals in his empire and border lands; mentions **Cholas, Pandyas, Satiyaputras, Keralaputras, and Antiochus II Theos of Syria**.
Major Rock Edict III	Liberal attitude towards Brahmanas and Shramanas; ordering **Yuktas, Rajukas, and Pradeshikas** to go on tour of inspection every 5 years (*Anusamyana*).
Major Rock Edict IV	Sound of Dhamma-ghosha replaced the sound of Bheri-ghosha (war drum).
Major Rock Edict V	Appointment of **Dhamma Mahamattas** (in 14th regnal year) to propagate morality.
Major Rock Edict VI	King's accessibility: reporters (**Pativedakas**) ordered to report public matters to Ashoka at all times and places.
Major Rock Edict VII	Universal religious tolerance among all sects.
Major Rock Edict VIII	Replaced royal pleasure trips (*Viharayatras*) with religious tours (**Dhammayatras**); visited Bodh Gaya in 10th regnal year.
Major Rock Edict IX	Condemned meaningless rituals and ceremonies; extolled Dhamma-mangala.
Major Rock Edict X	Denounced individual fame and glory in favour of moral attainment.
Major Rock Edict XI	Declared that the gift of Dhamma (*Dhamma-dana*) is the highest of all gifts.
Major Rock Edict XII	Directive on mutual tolerance among all religious sects; appointment of *Ithijhakha Mahamattas* (female affairs officers).

Edict	Core Subject / Mandate Inscribed
Major Rock Edict XIII	**MOST IMPORTANT EDICT**: Records the **Kalinga War (261 BCE, 8th regnal year)**, deep remorse over 1,00,000 killed and 1,50,000 captured; victory by Dhamma declared supreme; **mentions 5 contemporary Greek Kings**: 1. **Antiochus II Theos** (Syria) 2. **Ptolemy II Philadelphus** (Egypt) 3. **Antigonus Gonatas** (Macedonia) 4. **Magas** (Cyrene) 5. **Alexander** (Epirus).
Major Rock Edict XIV	Summarizes the purpose and recording of the various rock inscriptions.

5. Buddhism & Jainism Quick-Recall Matrix

A. The 4 Buddhist Councils (Memorize the Pattern!)

Council	Year	Venue	Patron King & Dynasty	President / Chairman	Landmark Accomplishment
1st	**483 BCE**	Saptaparni Cave, **Rajagriha**	**Ajatashatru** (Haryanka)	**Mahakassapa**	**Sutta Pitaka** (Ananda - Buddha's teachings) & **Vinaya Pitaka** (Upali - Monastic rules) compiled
2nd	**383 BCE**	**Vaishali**	**Kalashoka** (Shishunaga)	**Sabakami**	First schism: Split into **Sthaviravadins** (Theravadins) and **Mahasanghikas**
3rd	**250 BCE**	**Pataliputra**	**Ashoka** (Maurya)	**Moggaliputta Tissa**	**Abhidhamma Pitaka** compiled (philosophical analysis); Kathavatthu added; Missionaries sent abroad
4th	**72 CE**	Kundalvana (**Kashmir**)	**Kanishka** (Kushana)	**Vasumitra** (President), **Ashvaghosha** (Vice-President)	Final split into **Hinayana** and **Mahayana**; *Mahavibhasha Shastra* written in Sanskrit

B. Buddha's 5 Great Life Events & Symbols

1. **Janma (Birth)**: Lotus and Bull (**563 BCE**, Lumbini, Kapilavastu).
2. **Mahabhinishkramana (Great Renunciation)**: Horse (Kanthaka).
3. **Nirvana / Sambodhi (Enlightenment)**: Bodhi Tree (Pipal / Ficus religiosa) at Bodh Gaya on Niranjana (Phalgu) river.
4. **Dharmachakrapravartana (First Sermon)**: Wheel / 8-Spoked Chakra (Deer Park at Sarnath / Rishipattana).
5. **Mahaparinirvana (Death)**: Stupa / Footprints (Sal tree grove at Kushinagar, **483 BCE**, age **80**).

C. Birth and death of Buddha and Mahavira

Head	**Gautama Buddha (Siddhartha)**	**Mahavira (Vardhamana)**
Birth year	**563 BCE** (traditional; some books use a shorter chronology)	**599 BCE** (usual teaching set); some books use **540 BCE**
Birthplace	**Lumbini** (Nepal), near Kapilavastu of the **Shakya** clan	**Kundagrama** (Vaishali / Vajji belt, Bihar), **Jnatraka** clan
Parents	Father **Suddhodana**; mother **Mahamaya / Mayadevi** (Koliyan); raised by **Mahapajapati Gotami**	Father **Siddhartha**; mother **Trishala** (sister of Lichchhavi chief **Chetaka**)
Wife / child	**Yashodhara**; son **Rahul**	Jain tradition names wife **Yashoda** (a different person from Yashodhara)
Renunciation	Age **29** (*Mahabhinishkramana*; horse **Kanthaka**)	Age **30** (*grihatyaga*)

Head	Gautama Buddha (Siddhartha)	Mahavira (Vardhamana)
Awakening	Enlightenment at about **35**, **Bodh Gaya** (Vaishakha Purnima)	**Kevala jnana** at about **42**
Death year	**483 BCE** (*Mahaparinirvana*)	**527 BCE** (usual); some books use **468 BCE**
Death place	**Kushinagar** (UP, Malla republic), sala grove, age **80**	**Pavapuri / Pawa** (Bihar), age **72**
Proof of birthplace	Ashoka's **Rummindei** pillar at Lumbini	Kundagrama / Vaishali tradition; not marked by Rummindei

> **Logic:** Buddha **563–483 BCE**, 80 years. Mahavira **599–527 BCE**, 72 years. Do not swap Lumbini with Kundagrama, or Kushinagar with Pavapuri. **Nayaputta** is an epithet of **Mahavira**, not of Buddha. If a stem uses the shorter Jain pair **540–468 BCE**, both years still sit in the 6th–5th century BCE.

D. Jain Tirthankaras & Symbols (High-Frequency Match)

- **1st Rishabhanatha (Adinatha)**: **Bull** (Emblem) | Born in Ayodhya | Mentioned in Rigveda with Arishtanemi.
- **2nd Ajitanatha**: **Elephant** | Born in Ayodhya.
- **16th Shantinaatha**: **Deer**.
- **19th Mallinatha**: **Water Jar (Kalasha)** | Shvetambaras consider Mallinatha a female.
- **22nd Neminatha (Arishtanemi)**: **Conch (Shankha)** | Cousin of Krishna.
- **23rd Parshvanatha**: **Serpent / Hooded Cobra** | Born in Varanasi (Ashvasena's son); propounded 4 vows (*Chaturyama*).
- **24th Mahavira (Vardhamana)**: **Lion** | Born **599 BCE** at Kundagrama (Vaishali); died **527 BCE** at Pavapuri (age 72); added 5th vow: **Brahmacharya**.
- **Jain Councils**:
- **1st Council (c. 300 BCE)**: Pataliputra | Presided by **Sthulabhadra** | 12 Angas compiled | Split into Shvetambara (white-clad, led by Sthulabhadra) and Digambara (sky-clad, led by Bhadrabahu).
- **2nd Council (512 CE)**: Vallabhi (Gujarat) | Presided by **Devardhi Kshamasramana** | Final compilation of 12 Angas & 12 Upangas in Ardhamagadhi Prakrit.

---

6. Ancient Dynasties — From / To, Founder, Last Ruler, High-Yield

Magadha spine (do not skip a rung): **Haryanka → Shishunaga → Nanda → Maurya → Shunga → Kanva**.

Dynasty	Period (from–to)	Founder	Last ruler	Capital	Key ruler & high-yield
Haryanka	**c. 544–412 BCE**	**Bimbisara** (Shrenika; annexes **Anga**; contemporary of Buddha & Mahavira)	**Nagadasaka** (weak tail; minister Shishunaga takes the throne)	**Rajagriha / Girivraja**	**Ajatashatru** — *rathamusala*, war on Vajji, **1st Buddhist Council** (Rajagriha). **Udayin** first makes **Pataliputra** the Magadhan capital (Ajatashatru only seeds Pataligrama).
Shishunaga	**c. 412–344 BCE**	**Shishunaga** (ex-viceroy of Kashi)	**Nandivardhana / Mahanandin** (overthrown by Mahapadma Nanda)	Girivraja → **Vaishali** (second capital tradition)	Founder **takes Avanti / Malwa** (ends Pradyota). **Kalashoka / Kakavarna** — **2nd Buddhist Council** at Vaishali (schism). Did **not** found Pataliputra.

Dynasty	Period (from–to)	Founder	Last ruler	Capital	Key ruler & high-yield
Nanda	**c. 344–321 BCE**	**Mahapadma Nanda** (*Ekarat*, *Sarvakshatrantaka*, *Ugrasena*, *Aparoparashurama*)	**Dhana Nanda** (Greek **Agrammes / Xandrames**; commander Bhaddasala)	**Pataliputra**	Nine Nandas. Huge standing army; **Alexander never fought** them (326 BCE is still Dhana Nanda's reign). Hathigumpha later recalls a Nanda canal and a Jina image from Kalinga. Overthrown by **Chandragupta + Chanakya**.
Maurya	**c. 321–185 BCE**	**Chandragupta Maurya** (Greek *Sandrokottos*; Chanakya / Kautilya; treaty with Seleucus **c. 303 BCE**)	**Brihadratha** (killed by general **Pushyamitra Shunga**, 185 BCE)	**Pataliputra** (Ganga–Son)	**Bindusara** (*Amitraghata*). **Ashoka**: accession c. 272, coronation **268–232**; **Kalinga War 261 BCE** (MRE XIII); **3rd Council** at Pataliputra. Ashoka's death **232 ≠** end of empire — house runs to **185**.
Shunga	**185–73 BCE**	**Pushyamitra Shunga** (coup at a military review)	**Devabhuti** (killed / ousted by Vasudeva Kanva)	Pataliputra & **Vidisha**	Two **ashvamedhas** (Ayodhya / Dhanadeva record). **Agnimitra** (अग्निमित्र) in Kalidasa's (कालिदास) *Malavikagnimitra* (मालविकाग्निमित्रम्). **Patanjali** (*Mahabhashya* (महाभाष्य)) is Shunga-age, not Kanishka's court. Sanchi still grows.
Kanva	**73–28 BCE**	**Vasudeva Kanva**	**Susarman**	Pataliputra	Short Magadha coda after Shungas. Deccan **Satavahanas** rise as this house fades.
Satavahana (Andhra)	**c. 230 BCE – 3rd c. CE**	**Simuka**	Last great often **Yajna Sri Satakarni** (later Pulomavi line)	**Pratishthana (Paithan)** & Amaravati	**Gautamiputra Satakarni** — *Ekabrahmana*, *Trisamudrapitapoyavahana* (Nasik cave of mother **Gautami Balashri**); smashed Western Kshatrapas. **Lead & potin** coins; matrilineal *Gautamiputra / Vasisthiputra* titles. **Hala** — Prakrit *Gatha Saptasati*. Yajna Sri — **ship** on coins.
Kushana	**1st–3rd c. CE**	**Kujula Kadphises** (Kadphises I)	Last great **Vasudeva I** (then fragmentation)	**Purushapura (Peshawar)** & **Mathura**	**Vima Kadphises** — first Kushana **gold** (*dinar*). **Kanishka** — **Shaka era 78 CE** (some books peak c. 127); **4th Council** at Kundalvana (Kashmir); Gandhara + Mathura art; titles *Devaputra*. Do not make Kanishka a Gupta.
Gupta	**c. 320–550 CE**	**Sri Gupta** → **Ghatotkacha** (both *Maharaja*); real imperial start **Chandragupta I** (**Maharajadhiraja**, Gupta era **319/320 CE**, queen **Kumaradevi**)	Last great **Skandagupta**; later line thins (e.g. Vishnugupta)	**Pataliputra** (CG II also uses **Ujjain**)	**Samudragupta** — Prayag Prashasti by **Harisena**; *Napoleon of India*; Aryavarta uprooted, Dakshinapatha captured-and-freed. **Chandragupta II Vikramaditya** — *Sakari*, ends Western Kshatrapas (Rudrasimha III); Mehrauli iron pillar; Fa-Hien. **Kumaragupta I** — Nalanda tradition. **Skandagupta** — **Bhitari** (Ghazipur, UP) vs **Hunas**; repairs Sudarsana lake.

Dynasty	Period (from–to)	Founder	Last ruler	Capital	Key ruler & high-yield
Vakataka	**c. 250–500 CE**	**Vindhyashakti**	**Harishena** (Vatsagulma branch; Ajanta later caves)	**Vatsagulma** (Washim) / Nandivardhana	**Pravarasena I** — four *ashvamedhas*. Gupta–Vakataka tie: **Prabhavatigupta** (daughter of CG II) married **Rudrasena II** and ruled as regent.
Maukhari	**6th c. CE** (till **c. 606**)	**Harivarman**	**Grahavarman**	**Kannauj** (Kanyakubja, UP)	Grahavarman married **Rajyashri** (Harsha's sister); killed by **Deva Gupta of Malwa** + **Shashanka** of Gauda — the spark for Harsha's rise.
Pushyabhuti (Vardhana)	House earlier; **Harsha 606–647 CE**	**Pushyabhuti** (house); effective reunion king **Harshavardhana**	**Harsha** (no stable heir after **647**; Wang Xuance / Arunashva)	Thanesar → **Kannauj**	**Harsha-samvat 606**. Xuanzang (*Si-Yu-Ki*). Kannauj & Prayag assemblies. Stopped on the **Narmada** by **Pulakeshin II**. Banabhatta — *Harshacharita*. Not a Gupta emperor.
Badami Chalukya	**543–753 CE**	**Pulakeshin I**	**Kirtivarman II** (overthrown by Rashtrakuta **Dantidurga**)	**Vatapi (Badami**, Karnataka)	**Pulakeshin II** — defeats Harsha on Narmada; **Aihole / Meguti** prashasti by Jain poet **Ravikirti** (रविकीर्ति) (names **Kalidasa** (कालिदास) & **Bharavi** (भारवि)). Clash with Pallavas (Narasimhavarman I sacks Vatapi — *Vatapikonda*).
Pallava of Kanchi	**c. 575–897 CE**	**Simhavishnu** (imperial line)	**Aparajita** (defeated by Chola **Aditya I**)	**Kanchipuram**	**Mahendravarman I** — *Mattavilasa Prahasana*; rock-cut start. **Narasimhavarman I Mahamalla** — defeats Pulakeshin II; **Mamallapuram** rathas / shore temple age.

Logic: Maurya **321–185**, not 321–232. Gupta **320–550**, not "ends with Chandragupta II." Harsha **606–647** is Pushyabhuti, not Gupta. Shunga **185** is the Mauryan end, not Kalinga (261).

7. Epigraphy & Inscriptions (The Match-the-Following Goldmine)

Inscription	Place / State	King / Dynasty	Author / Key Fact
Prayag Prashasti (Allahabad Pillar)	Prayagraj (UP)	**Samudragupta** (Gupta)	Composed by court poet **Harisena** (हरिषेण) in *Champu* (चम्पू) (verse + prose) style in Sanskrit. Mentions *Digvijaya*, *Dakshinapatha* (12 kings - *Grahana-Mokshanugraha*), *Aryavarta* (9 kings exterminated). Also has inscriptions of Ashoka, Jahangir, Birbal!
Hathigumpha Inscription	Udayagiri hills, Bhubaneswar (Odisha)	**Kharavela** (Chedi/Mahameghavahana)	In Prakrit, Brahmi script. Mentions: canal dug by Nandaraja 300 yrs earlier brought to Kalinga, invasion of Magadha (*Bahisatimita* defeated), first epigraphic mention of **Bharatavarsha**.
Junagarh Rock Inscription	Girnar, Junagadh (Gujarat)	**Rudradaman I** (Western Kshatrapa, 150 CE)	**First chaste, elaborate Sanskrit inscription**. Records history of **Sudarshana Lake**: built under Chandragupta Maurya (Pushyagupta), canal added by Ashoka (Tushaspha), repaired by Rudradaman (Suvisakha) **without levying extra tax/Vishti**, later restored by Skandagupta (Chakrapalita)!

Inscription	Place / State	King / Dynasty	Author / Key Fact
Aihole Inscription	Bagalkot (Karnataka)	**Pulakeshin II** (Badami Chalukya)	Composed by Jain poet **Ravikirti** (रविकीर्ति) at Meguti temple. Mentions Pulakeshin II defeating Harshavardhana on the banks of Narmada; mentions poets **Kalidasa** (कालिदास) and **Bharavi** (भारवि).
Mehrauli Iron Pillar	Qutb Complex, Delhi	**Chandra** (Chandragupta II Vikramaditya)	Rustless iron metallurgy; defeated Vanga confederacy and crossed 7 mouths of Sindhu to defeat Vahlikas. Dedicated to Lord Vishnu (*Vishnupada*).
Nasik Cave Inscription	Nasik (Maharashtra)	**Gautamiputra Satakarni** (Satavahana)	Issued by his mother **Gautami Balashri**. Titles: *Ekabrahmana*, *Kshatriya-darpa-man-mardana*, *Trisamudrapitapoyavahana* (whose horses drank water of three seas).
Besnagar (Vidisha) Pillar	Vidisha (Madhya Pradesh)	**Bhagabhadra** (Shunga)	Erected by **Heliodorus** (Greek ambassador of King Antialcidas of Taxila); calls himself *Bhagavata* and dedicates Garuda-dhvaja to *Devadeva Vasudeva*.
Eran Inscription (510 CE)	Sagar (Madhya Pradesh)	**Bhanugupta** (Gupta)	**First epigraphic / dated evidence of Sati**: Goparaja (general) died fighting Hunas; his wife immolated herself on his funeral pyre.
Uttiramerur Inscription	Kanchipuram (Tamil Nadu)	**Parantaka I** (Chola, 10th c.)	In-depth details of **Chola village self-government**, Kudavolai (pot-ticket lot) system, and committee qualification rules for *Variyam*.
Rummindei Pillar Inscription	Lumbini (Nepal)	**Ashoka** (Maurya)	Commemorates Ashoka's visit to Buddha's birthplace (20th regnal year). **Tax concessions**: Land revenue (*Bhaga*) reduced from ⅙th to **⅛th**, and religious tribute (*Bali*) completely abolished.
Bhabru (Bairat) Edict	Rajasthan	**Ashoka** (Maurya)	Ashoka explicitly affirms faith in the **Buddha, Dhamma, and Sangha**; calls himself *Piyadassi Raja Magadha*.
Maski, Gurjara, Nittur, Udegolam	Karnataka & MP	**Ashoka** (Maurya)	Inscriptions where the personal name **"Ashoka"** is explicitly written (instead of just *Devanampiya Piyadassi*).
Sohgaura (Gorakhpur) & Mahasthangarh (Bogura)	UP & Bangladesh	Maurya Period	Copper plate & limestone plaque mentioning **famine relief measures** and state granary maintenance.

8. Ancient Ports & Ancient Coins

A. Major Ancient Indian Ports (Direct Match Questions)

- **Western Coast**:
- **Bharuch / Barygaza** (Narmada estuary, Gujarat): Most active port for trade with Roman Empire.
- **Sopara (Surparaka)** (near Mumbai, Maharashtra): Ashokan edict site; major trade center.
- **Kalyan (Calliena)** (Thane, Maharashtra).
- **Muziris / Kodungallur** (Periyar river mouth, Kerala): Roman trade hub; exported black pepper (**"Yavanapriya"**); temple of Augustus built here.
- **Nelcynda & Tyndis** (Kerala coast).
- **Eastern Coast**:
- **Tamralipti / Tamluk** (Midnapore, West Bengal - Hooghly river): Premier port for trade with Southeast Asia, China, and Sri Lanka; Fa-Hien sailed back to China from here.

- **Arikamedu (Podouke)** (near Puducherry): Roman trading post; excavated by Mortimer Wheeler; Roman amphorae, Arretine ware, and Roman coins found.
- **Poompuhar / Kaveripattinam** (Kaveri mouth, Tamil Nadu): Capital port of the Early Cholas (celebrated in *Silappadikaram*).
- **Korkai** (Tamil Nadu): Famous pearl-fishery port of the Pandyas.

B. Ancient Coins & Currency Units

- **Nishka / Satamana**: Gold ornaments/weights in Vedic period; later evolved into currency terms.
- **Karshapana / Pana**: Standard **silver punch-marked coins** (bearing symbols of sun, tree, hill, peacock) in Mauryan and Mahajanapada era.
- **First Gold Coins in India**: Issued by **Indo-Greeks (2nd c. BCE)**; also first to issue coins with portraits and legends of kings.
- **Largest Number of Pure Gold Coins**: Issued by **Kushanas** (Vima Kadphises and Kanishka - *Dinar* based on Roman denarius weight standard).
- **Largest Quantity of Gold Coins**: Issued by **Guptas** (*Dinar* for gold; *Rupaka* for silver, started by Chandragupta II after defeating Shakas).
- **Lead and Potin Coins**: Distinctive currency issued by the **Satavahanas**.
- **Cowries (Kaudi)**: Common medium of exchange for daily petty transactions (recorded by Fa-Hien in Gupta era).

9. Ancient Indian Administrative Officers Master Matrix

A. Mauryan Central Administration (Arthashastra & Edicts)

- **Central Tirthas (18 Supreme Functionaries)**: Top cabinet-level officials including *Mantri* (Prime Minister), *Purohita* (Chief Priest), *Senapati* (Army Chief), *Yuvaraja* (Crown Prince), and the two supreme fiscal heads:
- **Samaharta (समाहर्ता)**: **Collector General of Revenue** — responsible for preparing the annual state budget, assessing revenues, and overseeing tax collection across the entire empire (rural, urban, mines, forests).
- **Sannidhata (सन्निधाता)**: **Chief Treasury Officer & Custodian of Royal Storehouses** (*Koshadhyaksha*) — responsible for the safe keeping of the state treasury, constructing granaries, treasuries, and warehouses.
- **Megasthenes' Administrative Officials in *Indica***:
- **Astynomoi (नगर अध्यक्ष)**: 30 city officials of Pataliputra divided into **6 boards of 5 members each**:
    1. *Board 1*: Industrial arts & crafts inspection.
    2. *Board 2*: Care and surveillance of foreign visitors.
    3. *Board 3*: Registration of vital statistics (births and deaths).
    4. *Board 4*: Trade, commerce, and regulation of markets.
    5. *Board 5*: Inspection of manufactured goods and distinguishing new from old.
    6. *Board 6*: Collection of the **10% sales tax** on goods sold (evasion was punishable by death).
- **Agronomoi (जिला / ग्रामीण अधिकारी)**: Rural and district officers in charge of land measurement, irrigation canals, agriculture, timber, mining, and road maintenance (installed milestones every 10 stadia).
- **Ashoka's Key Administrative Cadres**:
- **Rajuka (रज्जुक)**: District administrator in charge of land survey, revenue assessment, and judicial administration (Ashoka granted them full independence in judicial punishment).
- **Yukta (युक्त)**: Subordinate secretarial officer / district accountant assisting the Rajukas.
- **Pradeshika (प्रादेशिक)**: Head of provincial/divisional administration on regular five-year inspection tours (*Anusamyana*).
- **Dhamma Mahamatta (धम्म महामात्र)**: High-ranking moral officials instituted in Ashoka's 14th regnal year (Rock Edict V) to propagate Dhamma, prevent arbitrary imprisonment, and supervise religious harmony.

B. Kautilya's 20+ Key Adhyakshas (Department Superintendents)

Adhyaksha (Superintendent)	Department / Administrative Portfolio	Exam Keyword / Function
Sitadhyaksha (सीताध्यक्ष)	**Agriculture & Crown Lands**	Supervised state farms (*Sita* lands) and farming labour
Pautavadhyaksha (पौतवाध्यक्ष)	**Weights and Measures**	Standardized scales and measures across markets
Panyadhyaksha (पण्याध्यक्ष)	**Trade and Commerce**	Regulated supply, pricing, and distribution of state merchandise
Samsthadhyaksha (संस्थाध्यक्ष)	**Markets and Guilds**	Monitored markets, prevented cartelization and cheating
Sulkadhyaksha (शुल्काध्यक्ष)	**Tolls, Customs & Octroi**	Collected transit duties and import/export taxes
Rupadarshaka (रूपदर्शक)	**Currency & Coinage Inspector**	Examined purity of punch-marked silver coins (*Pana*)
Akshapataladhyaksha (अक्षपटलाध्यक्ष)	**Accountant General & Archives**	Maintained central accounts, ledgers, and state audit
Mudradhyaksha (मुद्राध्यक्ष)	**Passports & State Seals**	Issued identity tokens and regulated travel/emigration
Navadhyaksha (नावाध्यक्ष)	**Shipping, Ferries & Waterways**	Managed maritime trade, rivers, ports, and toll-ferries
Akaradhyaksha (आकराध्यक्ष)	**Mines and Metallurgy**	Controlled state monopoly over mineral extraction
Lohadhyaksha (लोहाध्यक्ष)	**Iron and Metal Manufacture**	Supervised manufacture of iron weapons and tools
Suradhyaksha (सुराध्यक्ष)	**Liquor and Excise**	Regulated state breweries and alcohol taverns
Sunadhyaksha (सूनाध्यक्ष)	**Slaughterhouses & Animal Care**	Prevented cruelty and controlled meat production
Ganikadhyaksha (गणिकाध्यक्ष)	**Courtesans & Entertainers**	Regulated public entertainers, dancers, and royal spies
Vivitadhyaksha (विवीताध्यक्ष)	**Pastures and Grazing Lands**	Managed grazing grounds, dug wells, maintained security
Kupyadhyaksha (कुप्याध्यक्ष)	**Forest Produce & Timber**	Managed state forests, timber, and wild elephant reserves
Koshadhyaksha (कोषाध्यक्ष)	**Imperial Treasury**	Subordinate to Sannidhata; guarded gold, gems, and bullion
Ayudhagaradhyaksha (आयुधागाराध्यक्ष)	**Armoury & Weapons Storage**	Manufactured and preserved arms and military gear
Hastyadhyaksha (हस्त्यध्यक्ष)	**War Elephant Force**	Training, feeding, and deploying royal elephant corps
Ashvadhyaksha (अश्वाध्यक्ष)	**Cavalry & Royal Stables**	Imported and maintained war horses

C. Gupta & Harsha Administrative Officers

Officer Designation	Dynasty / Period	Portfolio / Exact Role
Kumaramatya (कुमारमात्य)	Gupta	**Elite administrative cadre**; equivalent to modern IAS; served as provincial governors, ministers, generals
Mahabaladhikrita (महाबलाधिकृत)	Gupta & Harsha	**Commander-in-Chief** of the imperial army
Mahadandanayaka (महादंडनायक)	Gupta	**Chief Judicial & Police Magistrate** (Harisena held Kumaramatya, Sandhivigrahika, and Mahadandanayaka)
Sandhivigrahika (सांधिविग्रहिक)	Gupta (started under Samudragupta)	**Minister for Peace and War** (Foreign Minister)

Officer Designation	Dynasty / Period	Portfolio / Exact Role
Mahapratihara (महाप्रतिहार)	Gupta & Harsha	**Chief of Palace Guards** and Lord Chamberlain
Uparika (उपरिक)	Gupta & Harsha	**Provincial Governor**; head of a *Bhukti* (province)
Vishayapati (विषयपति)	Gupta	**Head of a District** (*Vishaya*); administered with 4-member city council (*Adhisthana-adhikarana*): 1. *Nagara-sreshthi* (Chief of guild/banker) 2. *Sarthavaha* (Caravan merchant chief) 3. *Prathama-kulika* (Chief artisan) 4. *Prathama-kayastha* (Chief scribe/writer)
Pustapala (पुस्तपाल)	Gupta	**Keeper of land records and revenue surveys**
Shaulkika (शौल्किक)	Gupta	Collector of toll and customs duties (*Shulka*)
Dandapasika / Chauroddharanika	Gupta	Police officer / investigator in charge of catching thieves and criminals
Bhandagaradhikarana	Harsha	Chief superintendent of the royal treasury and storehouse

D. Chola Local Administration & Committees (Uttiramerur Inscription)

- **Three Core Assemblies**:
- **Ur**: General assembly of common tax-paying villagers in non-Brahmana settlements.
- **Sabha / Mahasabha**: Assembly of learned Brahmanas in tax-free **Brahmadeya / Agrahara** villages.
- **Nagaram**: Council of merchants and traders in commercial towns.
- **Variyam (Executive Standing Committees of Sabha)**:
- **Samvatsara-variyam**: Annual executive governing committee.
- **Eri-variyam**: **Tank and irrigation committee** (supervised desilting and water sharing).
- **Totta-variyam**: Garden and orchard committee.
- **Pon-variyam**: Gold and treasury assessment committee.
- **Panchavara-variyam**: Standing committee for general supervision.
- **Kudavolai System (कुदवोलाई)**: Pot-ticket lot system where candidates' names on palm leaves were drawn from an earthen pot by a young boy to ensure impartial committee selection.

10. Ancient Indian Taxes & Fiscal Terms Master Matrix

Tax / Fiscal Term	Period / Civilization	Nature of Levy / Source of Collection	High-Yield Exam Lock
Bali (बलि)	Vedic → Maurya	Vedic: Voluntary offering to Rajan in Rigveda → **Compulsory tax** in Later Vedic. Maurya: Religious tribute / additional land cess (Ashoka abolished Bali at Lumbini).	Voluntary in Rigveda; compulsory later
Bhaga (भाग)	Vedic → Maurya → Gupta	**King's royal share of agricultural produce**, traditionally fixed at **⅙th (*Shadbhaga*)**. Reduced to ⅛th by Ashoka at Lumbini.	Standard ⅙th land revenue
Sita (सीता)	Mauryan	**Revenue from crown agricultural lands** managed directly by the *Sitadhyaksha*.	Crown land revenue (distinct from Bhaga)
Kara (कर)	Mauryan & Gupta	Periodical tax levied on property, or specific tax levied on fruit, flower, and vegetable orchards.	Specific / periodic property tax
Vishti (विष्टि)	Maurya & Gupta	**Forced, unpaid labor** demanded by the state from artisans and peasants for public works.	Unpaid forced labor; treated as state income in Junagarh

Tax / Fiscal Term	Period / Civilization	Nature of Levy / Source of Collection	High-Yield Exam Lock
Pranaya (प्रणय)	Mauryan	**Emergency war tax / gift of affection** levied during acute financial crisis (demanded ⅓ to ¼ of produce).	Emergency fiscal levy
Vartani (वर्तनी)	Mauryan	**Transit duty / road cess** collected on goods by frontier officers (*Antapala*).	Transit duty / toll
Shulka (शुल्क)	Vedic → Gupta	**Customs duty, octroi, and toll taxes** levied on merchandise entering ports or market towns.	Toll / customs tax
Udakabhaga (उदकभाग)	Mauryan	**Water tax / irrigation cess** levied on farmers using state-constructed canals/lakes (varying from ⅕th to ⅓rd).	Irrigation / water cess
Hiranya (हिरण्य)	Maurya & Gupta	**Tax paid in cash / gold** (as opposed to payment in agricultural kind).	Cash tax (gold/coins)
Pindakara (पिण्डकर)	Mauryan	Lump-sum tax assessed collectively on an entire village community.	Collective village tax
Bhoga (भोग)	Gupta	**Daily customary tribute** of fruits, flowers, vegetables, and firewood offered by villagers to the king.	Daily tribute in kind (fruit/firewood)
Udranga (उद्रंग)	Gupta	Land revenue tax levied on **permanent tenants / water tax**.	Tax on permanent cultivators
Uparikara (उपरिकर)	Gupta	Additional tax levied on **temporary cultivators / non-permanent tenants**.	Tax on temporary tenants
Halikakara (हलिककर)	Gupta	**Plough tax** levied per plough owned by the peasant.	Tax per plough
Kadamai / Kudimai	Chola	**Primary land revenue** payable in paddy or cash to the king.	Main Chola land revenue
Vetti / Vetti-muttavalu	Chola	**Unpaid communal forced labor** for public tanks, temples, and palaces.	Chola forced labor (equivalent to Vishti)
Amanji	South India	Gratuitous labor or personal service to royal officials.	Personal royal service
Iraiyili (इरैयिली)	Chola / South India	**Tax-free land grant** bestowed upon temples (*Devadana*) or Brahmanas (*Brahmadeya*).	Tax-exempt land
Karai (करै)	Sangam	Land tax levied on agricultural produce by Tamil kings.	Sangam land tax
Ulgu / Sungam	Sangam & Chola	Customs duties, transit fees, and octroi tolls on trade caravans.	Toll / customs
Iravu (इरवु)	Sangam	Extra forced contribution or emergency demand made by the king.	Forced emergency demand

11. Ancient Land Classifications, Social Systems & Sangam Eco-Zones

A. 5 Types of Land in Ancient India (Gupta Inscriptions & Amarakosha)

1. **Kshetra (क्षेत्र)**: Land fit for **cultivation and agriculture**.
2. **Khila (खिल)**: **Waste, fallow, or uncultivated land**.
3. **Aprahata (अप्रहत)**: **Virgin, uncultivated jungle / forest land**.
4. **Vasti (वास्तु)**: **Habitable land** suitable for building homesteads and residential houses.
5. **Gapata-Sarah (गपत-सरह)**: **Pasture land** reserved for grazing cattle.

> **Ancient Land Tenure Systems:** - **Nivi-dharma (नीवी धर्म)**: Perpetual land endowment where the recipient enjoys income in perpetuity without right to sell or transfer ownership. - **Aprada-dharma (अप्रदा धर्म)**: Grantee can enjoy the revenue but has zero right to alienate or destroy property. - **Bhumi-chhidra-nyaya (भूमि-छिद्र-न्याय)**: Customary right of first clearance: anyone who clears virgin/waste land acquires ownership rights over it.

B. The 8 Types of Hindu Marriage (Manusmriti)

- **Approved / Dharmya Marriages (Prashasta — 4 Types)**:
- **Brahma**: Father gifts decorated daughter to a learned, virtuous groom without demanding dowry (Highest & purest form).
- **Daiva**: Father gives daughter to an officiating priest during a formal Vedic sacrifice.
- **Arsha**: Groom offers a pair of cows and a bull to the bride's father to fulfill religious duties (not as bride-price).
- **Prajapatya**: Father gifts daughter with blessing: "*May both of you perform your religious duties together*".
- **Unapproved / Adharmya Marriages (Aprashasta — 4 Types)**:
- **Asura**: Groom buys the bride by paying money/wealth to her father and relatives (Bride-price marriage).
- **Gandharva**: Love marriage based on mutual passion between bride and groom without parents' consent (e.g., Dushyanta & Shakuntala).
- **Rakshasa**: Forcible abduction and marriage of a crying maiden after fighting and slaying her kinsmen.
- **Paishacha**: Ravishing a maiden while she is asleep, intoxicated, or mentally deranged (Lowest and most sinful form).

> **Varna Marriage Rules:** - **Anuloma (अनुलोम)**: Marriage of a higher varna male with a lower varna female (Permitted by Dharma texts). - **Pratiloma (प्रतिलोम)**: Marriage of a lower varna male with a higher varna female (Severely condemned; produced untouchables/Chandalas).

C. Sangam Five Landscapes (Ainthinai / 5 Tinai)

Each Tinai represents an ecological zone, characteristic deity, and primary livelihood:

Tinai (Landscape)	Eco-Zone / Topography	Presiding Deity	Primary Livelihood / Occupation
Kurinji (कुरिंजी)	**Hilly / Mountainous**	**Murugan** (Seyon - God of War)	Hunting, honey-gathering, shifting cultivation
Mullai (मुल्लै)	**Forest / Pastoral Grasslands**	**Mayon** (Vishnu / Krishna)	Cattle-rearing, pastoralism, dairy farming
Marudam (मरुदम)	**Fertile Agricultural Plains**	**Vendan** (Indra - God of Rain)	Wet-paddy agriculture, farming
Neydal (नेयदाल)	**Coastal / Littoral Belt**	**Varunan** (God of the Sea)	Fishing, boat building, salt manufacturing
Palai (पालै)	**Arid / Desert / Parched Land**	**Korravai** (Goddess of Victory/War)	Highway robbery, raiding, military plunder